

NBA Draft Party Game

MASTER PROJECT BLUEPRINT & TECHNICAL SPECIFICATION | SINGLE-DEVICE COUCH CO-OP

1. Executive Summary & Vision

This project is a high-energy, fast-paced party game built for friends in the same room. It combines real-time psychological bidding, basketball analytics, and team chemistry into an engaging digital draft experience. Optimized for mobile devices (pass-and-play on a single shared screen), the game leverages the Modern Era NBA player pool (2010s to present) to avoid historical clutter while maximizing player recognition and banter.

2. Game Modes

- **Mode A: Frankenstein (Build-A-Player):** Players draft individual attributes category by category to build the ultimate custom superstar.
- **Mode B: The Franchise (5v5 Team Draft):** Players draft a full roster of 5 starters plus a 6th Man rotation player. Positions are switchable, and tactical depth is tested through team chemistry and attribute synergies.

3. Economy & Live Bidding Mechanics

The \$25 Strict Budget Cap: Each player starts with a virtual budget of exactly **\$25**. There are no fixed starting prices on player cards—all valuations are 100% dictated by live open-market bidding.

- **Nomination & Bidding:** A player is nominated onto the auction block. Any participant can start or raise the bid starting at **\$1**.
- **The Zero-Dollar Penalty Loop:** If a player blows all their cash early (\$0 balance) and opponents refuse to bid on an active player, the broke player is **unwillingly forced to take the player for free (\$0)**, filling their roster with unwanted fit penalties.

4. The 8 Core Attribute Pillars

Every player in the curated 50-player dataset is graded across 8 distinct categories using a letter grade system (S, A, B, C, D) which maps directly to internal numeric weights for scoring calculations:

- **Size:** Height, wingspan, and physical frame advantage.
- **Shooting:** 3-point range, pull-up gravity, and true shooting efficiency.
- **Finishing:** Rim pressure, contact conversion, and floaters.
- **Playmaking:** P&R execution, assist-to-turnover ratio, and passing vision.
- **IQ:** Off-ball cutting, defensive positioning, and mistake-free decision making.

- **Defense:** On-ball lockdown capability, rim protection, and versatility.
- **Mentality:** Clutch gene, leadership, and consistency under pressure.
- **Athleticism:** Speed, vertical burst, quickness, and stamina.

5. Chemistry & Synergy Engine

Raw math alone does not win championships. Team composition triggers active synergy bonuses or severe penalties:

- **"Dynamic Duo" Synergy:** Pairing an S-Tier Playmaker with an A/S-Tier Finisher grants a glowing badge effect and a **+6% team rating boost**.
- **"Floor Spacers" Synergy:** Having 3+ players with 'A' or 'S' Shooting grades unlocks elite floor spacing bonuses.
- **"Clogged Paint" Penalty:** Stacking 3+ slashers with poor outside shooting (C or D grade) triggers a **-6% penalty** due to terrible spacing chemistry.

6. Dataset & Technical Stack Overview

The companion file `nba_modern_players.json` contains 50 meticulously balanced modern NBA players complete with ratings across all 8 attributes. The frontend is designed for mobile web (React + Tailwind CSS + Framer Motion) with 3D card tilt effects, pulsing auction tickers, and animated chemistry liquid gauges.

Prepared for development handoff | Target Platform: Mobile Web / Shared Screen Couch Co-Op